Crafting the Perfect Desktop End-User UX





glueck kanja

DEVICIE

nerdio



About

End-user computing

engineer, consultant, pre-sales, architect, developer

Office of the CTO

nerdio

Evergreen





aaronedwardparker

@stealthpuppy

stealthpuppy.com





AGENDA

01 Setting the scene

02 Poor vs. good user experience

03 Tools & configurations

04 Set up and testing

05 Deep dive and discussion

06 Take aways





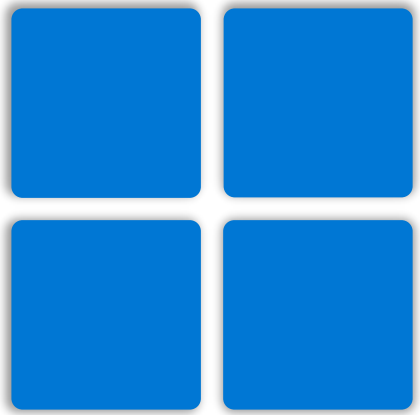
When IT issues decrease, employees view IT & company investment more favorably.



What are we trying to solve?

1. Deliver an exceptional, enterprise-grade user experience every time
2. A consistent experience across Windows PCs, Windows 365 & AVD
3. Make device provisioning more consistent

Windows PCs



Azure Virtual Desktop



Windows 365



Why

Why does user experience matter?

Boost productivity

Improve satisfaction

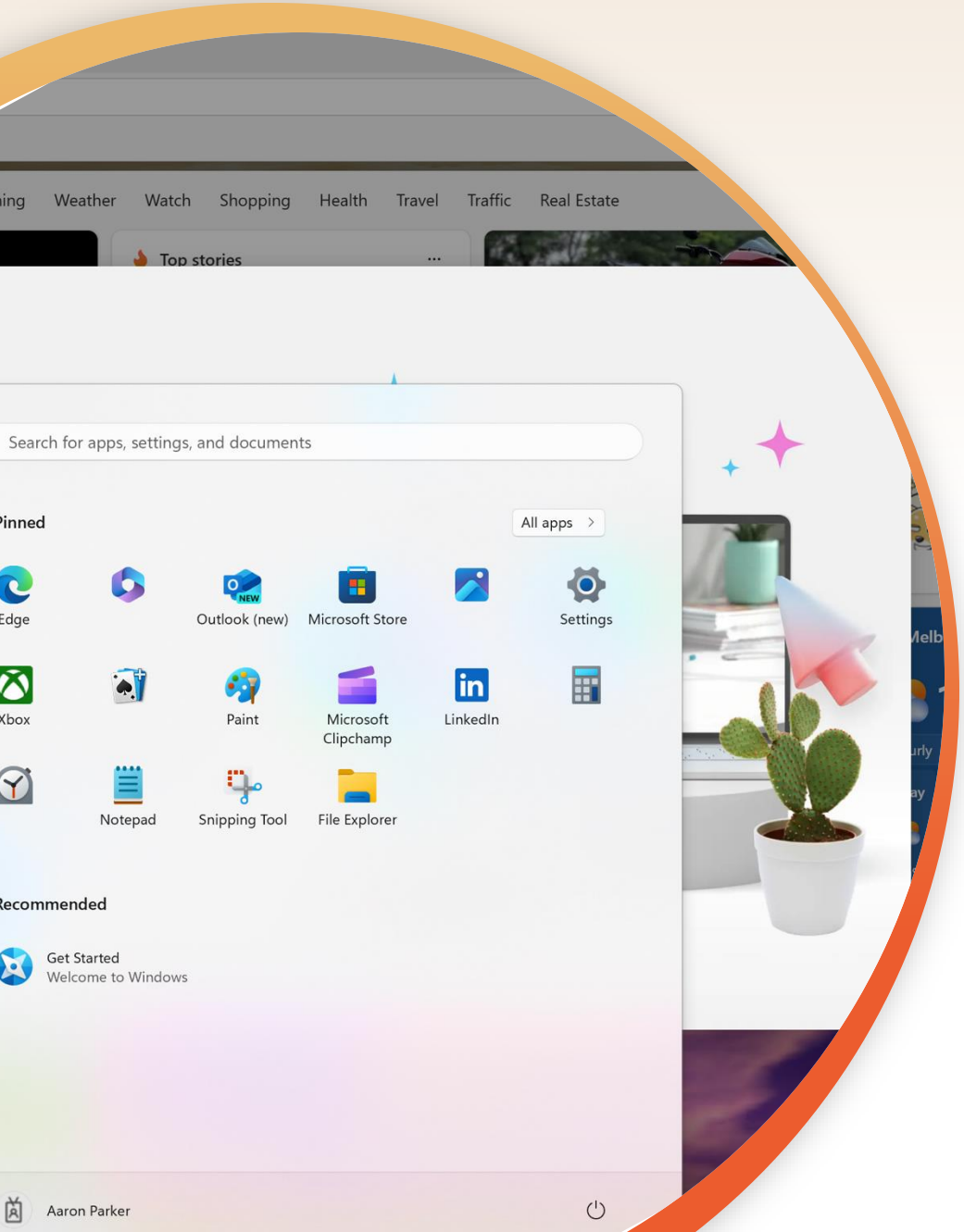
Increase performance





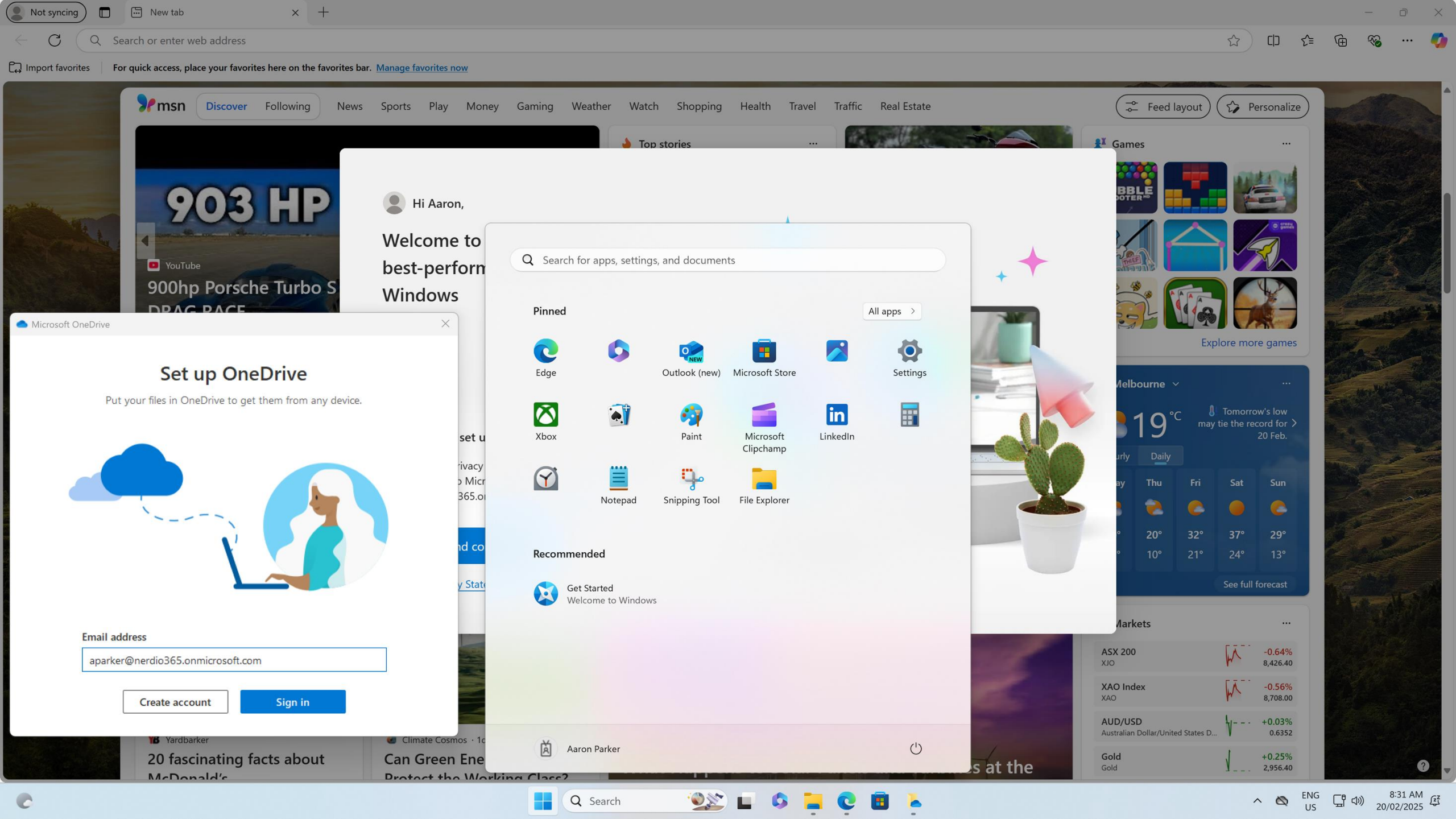
What’s a poor user experience?

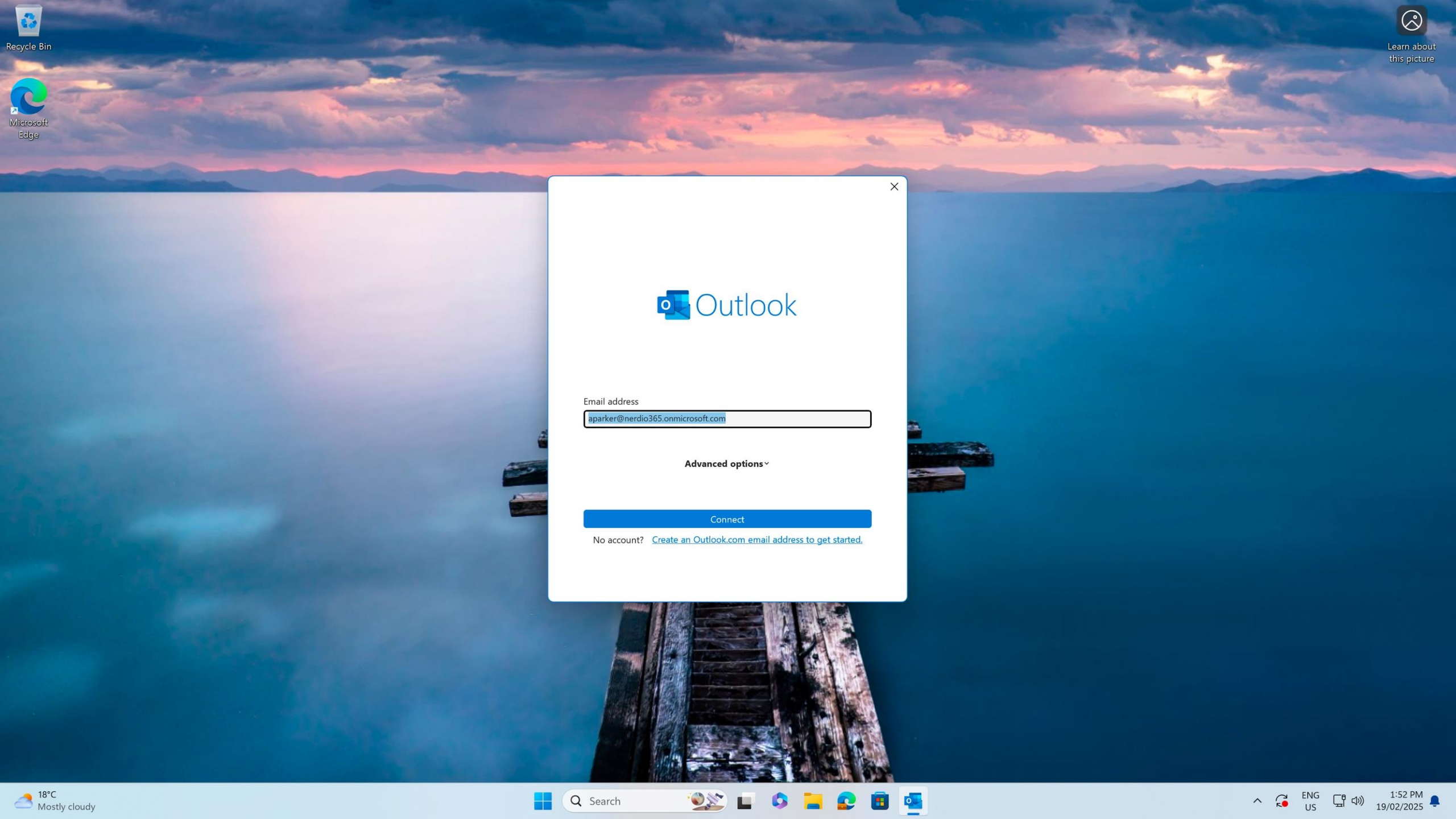




What's a poor user experience?

- Consumer features & unnecessary apps
- Interruptions to the user's workflow
- First run wizards & configuration questions
- Poor performance
- Latency

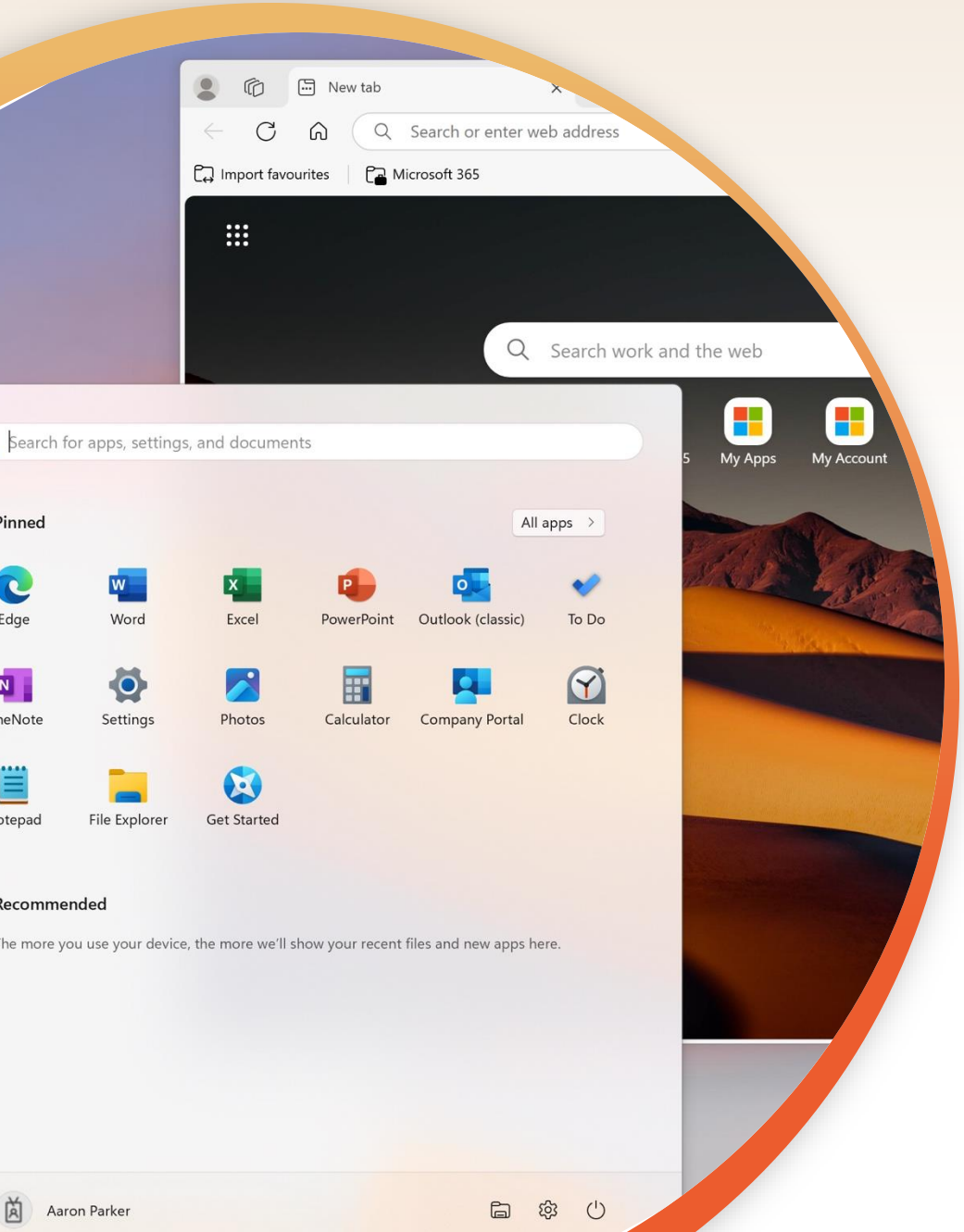

Not syncing
New tab
Search or enter web address
Import favorites
For quick access, place your favorites here on the favorites bar. Manage favorites now
msn
Discover
Following
News
Sports
Play
Money
Gaming
Weather
Watch
Shopping
Health
Travel
Traffic
Real Estate
Feed layout
Personalize
903 HP
YouTube
900hp Porsche Turbo S
Top stories
Games
Explore more games
Hi Aaron,
Welcome to
best-perform
Windows
Search for apps, settings, and documents
Pinned
All apps
Edge
Outlook (new)
Microsoft Store
Settings
Xbox
Paint
Microsoft Clipchamp
LinkedIn
Notepad
Snipping Tool
File Explorer
Recommended
Get Started
Welcome to Windows
Aaron Parker
Microsoft OneDrive
Set up OneDrive
Put your files in OneDrive to get them from any device.
Email address
aparker@nerdio365.onmicrosoft.com
Create account
Sign in
Melbourne
19 °C
Tomorrow's low may tie the record for 20 Feb.
Daily
Thu
Fri
Sat
Sun
20°
32°
37°
29°
10°
21°
24°
13°
See full forecast
Markets
ASX 200
XJO
-0.64%
8,426.40
XAO Index
XAO
-0.56%
8,708.00
AUD/USD
Australian Dollar/United States D...
+0.03%
0.6352
Gold
Gold
+0.25%
2,956.40
Yardbarker
20 fascinating facts about
Climate Cosmos
Can Green Ene
Search
ENG
US
8:31 AM
20/02/2025


Recycle Bin
Microsoft Edge
Learn about this picture
Outlook
Email address
aparker@nerdio365.onmicrosoft.com
Advanced options
Connect
No account?
Create an Outlook.com email address to get started.
18°C
Mostly cloudy
Search
ENG
US
1:52 PM
19/02/2025



What's a great user experience?

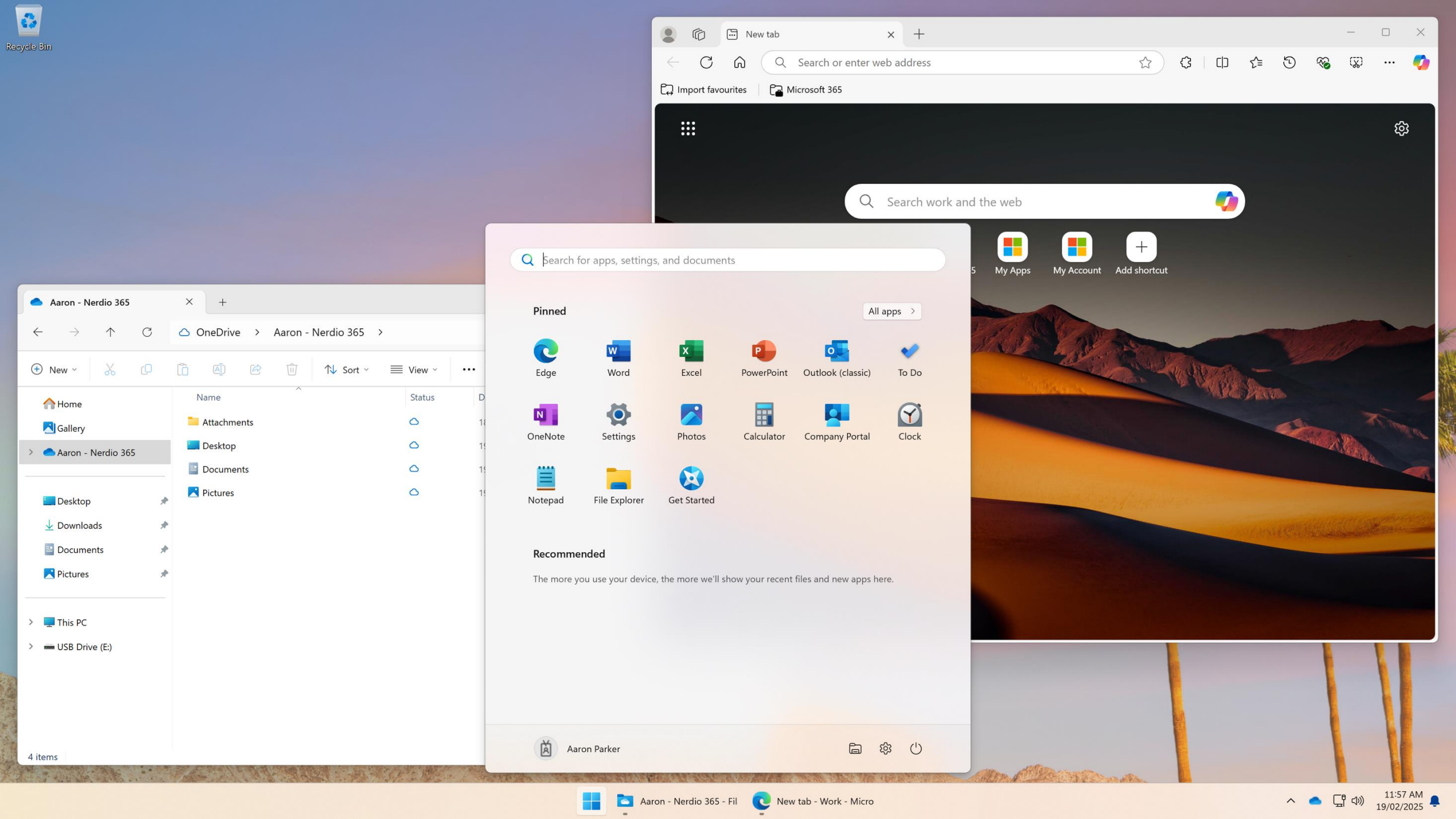




Why optimize the desktop?

User experience is key

- Less noise
- Faster to “usable”
- Speeds new device deployment or resets
- Happy users
- Consistent experience


Recycle Bin
New tab
Search or enter web address
Import favourites
Microsoft 365
Search work and the web
My Apps
My Account
Add shortcut
Search for apps, settings, and documents
Pinned
All apps
Edge
Word
Excel
PowerPoint
Outlook (classic)
To Do
OneNote
Settings
Photos
Calculator
Company Portal
Clock
Notepad
File Explorer
Get Started
Recommended
The more you use your device, the more we'll show your recent files and new apps here.
Aaron Parker
Aaron - Nerdio 365
OneDrive
Aaron - Nerdio 365
New
Sort
View
Home
Gallery
Aaron - Nerdio 365
Desktop
Downloads
Documents
Pictures
This PC
USB Drive (E:)
Name
Status
Attachments
Desktop
Documents
Pictures
4 items
Aaron - Nerdio 365 - Fil
New tab - Work - Micro
11:57 AM
19/02/2025

Time & language › Language & region

Some of these settings are managed by your organisation.

Language

Windows display language
Windows features like Settings and File Explorer will appear in this language
English (Australia)

Preferred languages
Microsoft Store apps will appear in the first supported language in this list
Add a language

English (Australia)
language pack, text-to-speech, speech recognition, handwriting, basic typing

Region

Country or region
Windows and apps might use your country or region to give you local content
Australia

Regional format
Windows and some apps format dates and times based on your regional format
Recommended

Time & language › Date & time

2:34 PM

Wednesday, 19 February 2025

Time zone
(UTC+10:00) Canberra, Melbourne, Sydney

Region
Australia

Set the time zone automatically — On

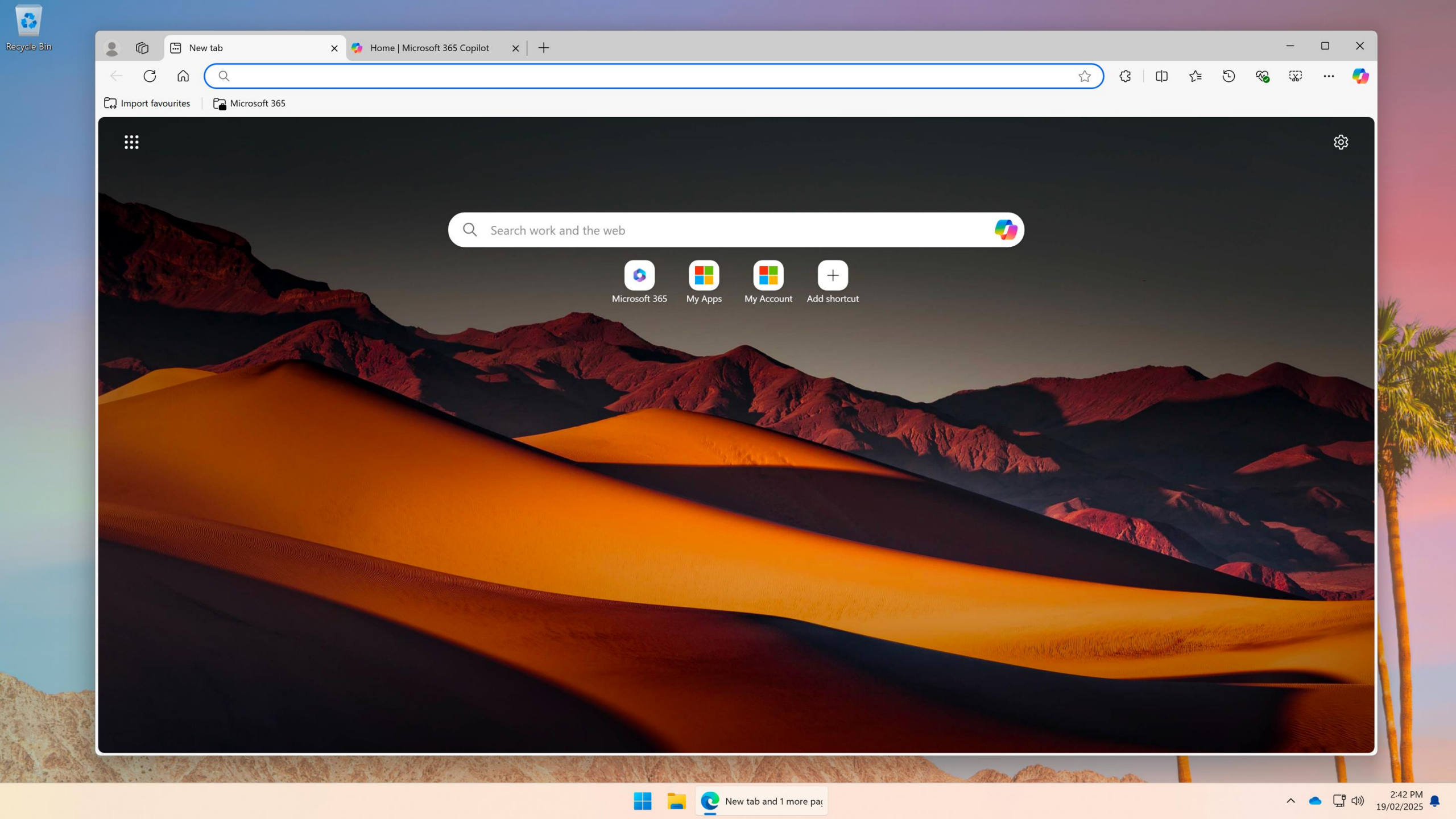
Set the time automatically — On

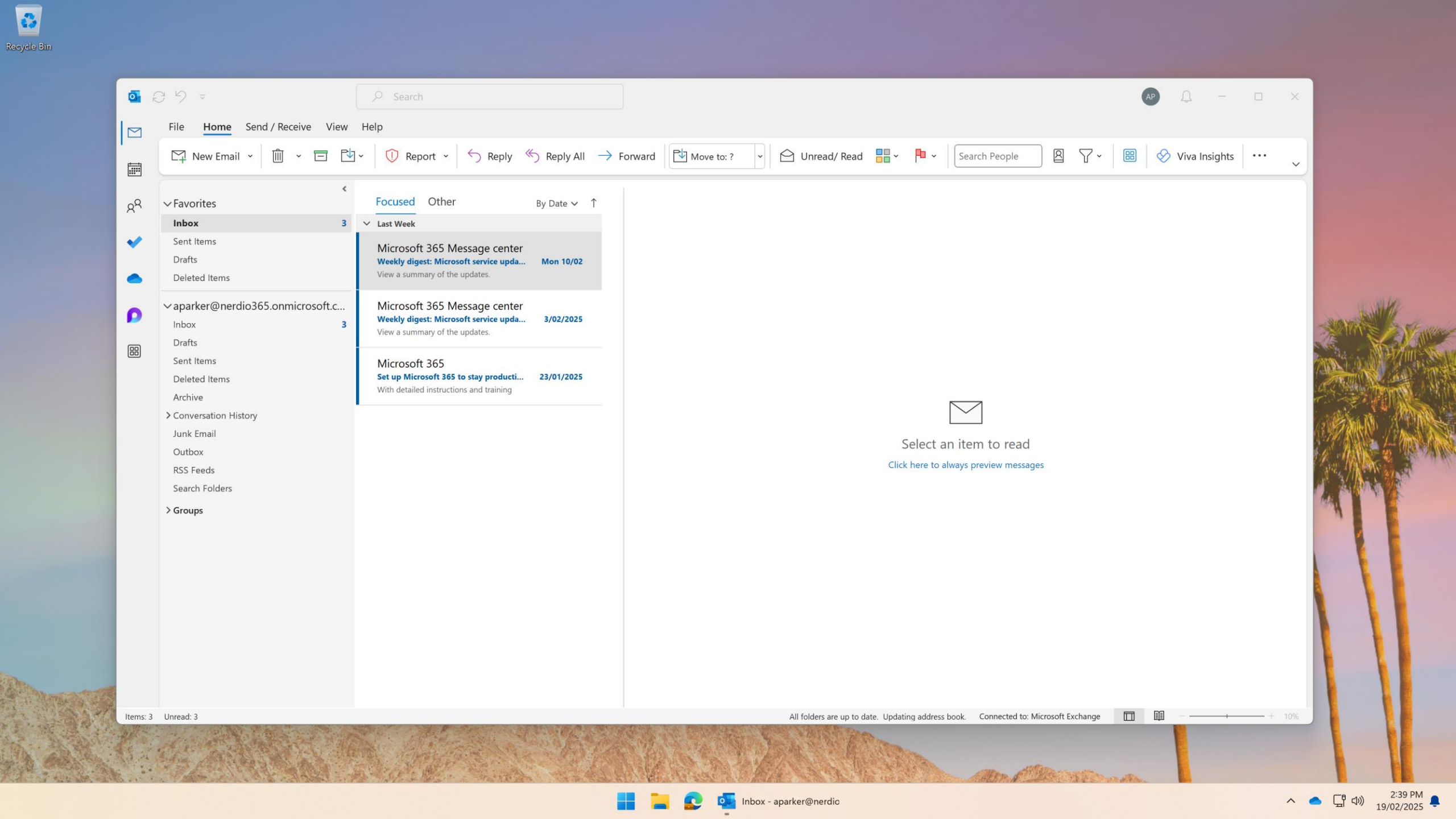
Show time and date in the System tray
Turn this off to hide your time and date information on the taskbar — On

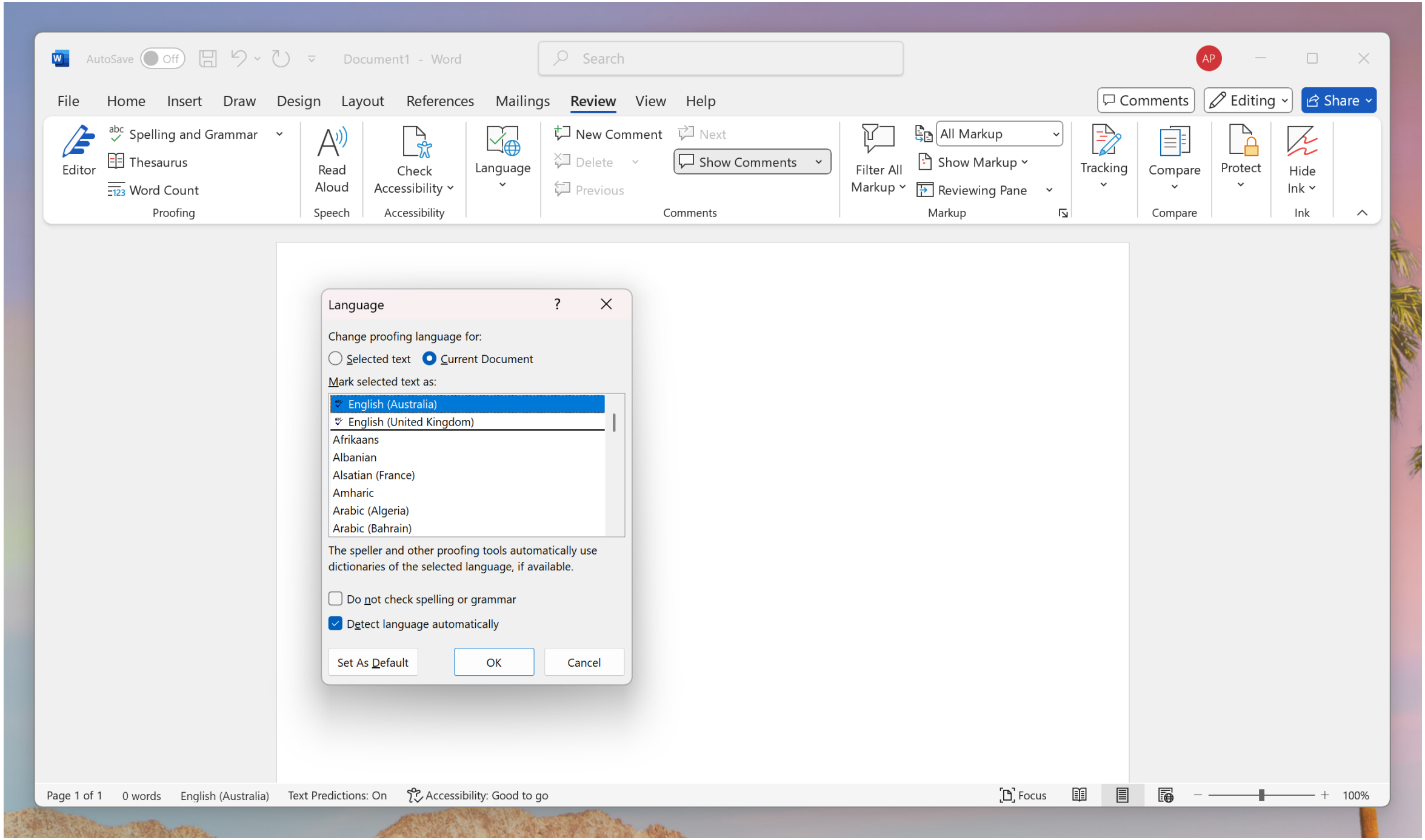
Additional settings

Sync now
Last successful time synchronisation: unspecified
Time server: unspecified
Sync now

Show additional calendars in the taskbar — Don't show additional calendars


Recycle Bin
New tab
Home | Microsoft 365 Copilot
Import favourites
Microsoft 365
Search work and the web
Microsoft 365
My Apps
My Account
Add shortcut
New tab and 1 more pag
2:42 PM
19/02/2025


Recycle Bin
Search
AP
File
Home
Send / Receive
View
Help
New Email
Report
Reply
Reply All
Forward
Move to: ?
Unread/ Read
Search People
Viva Insights
Favorites
Inbox 3
Sent Items
Drafts
Deleted Items
aparker@nerdio365.onmicrosoft.c...
Inbox 3
Drafts
Sent Items
Deleted Items
Archive
Conversation History
Junk Email
Outbox
RSS Feeds
Search Folders
Groups
Focused
Other
By Date
Last Week
Microsoft 365 Message center
Weekly digest: Microsoft service upda...
Mon 10/02
View a summary of the updates.
Microsoft 365 Message center
Weekly digest: Microsoft service upda...
3/02/2025
View a summary of the updates.
Microsoft 365
Set up Microsoft 365 to stay producti...
23/01/2025
With detailed instructions and training
Select an item to read
Click here to always preview messages
Items: 3
Unread: 3
All folders are up to date.
Updating address book.
Connected to: Microsoft Exchange
10%
Inbox - aparker@nerdio
2:39 PM
19/02/2025


AutoSave Off
Document1 - Word
Search
AP
File Home Insert Draw Design Layout References Mailings Review View Help
Comments Editing Share
Editor
Spelling and Grammar
Thesaurus
Word Count
Proofing
Read Aloud
Speech
Check Accessibility
Accessibility
Language
New Comment
Delete
Previous
Next
Show Comments
Comments
Filter All Markup
All Markup
Show Markup
Reviewing Pane
Markup
Tracking
Compare
Compare
Protect
Hide Ink
Ink
Language
Change proofing language for:
Selected text
Current Document
Mark selected text as:
English (Australia)
English (United Kingdom)
Afrikaans
Albanian
Alsatian (France)
Amharic
Arabic (Algeria)
Arabic (Bahrain)
The speller and other proofing tools automatically use dictionaries of the selected language, if available.
Do not check spelling or grammar
Detect language automatically
Set As Default
OK
Cancel
Page 1 of 1
0 words
English (Australia)
Text Predictions: On
Accessibility: Good to go
Focus
100%



Creating great a Windows user experience



Windows Enterprise Defaults

PowerShell solution for machine level settings & the default user profile: https://stealthpuppy.com/defaults/

Machine

- Machine-level configurations & optimisations
- Supports client & server

User

- Default user profile optimisations
- Default Start menu

Virtual Desktops

- Virtual desktop specific optimisations for performance gains

Administrator: C:\WINDOWS\system32\cmd.exe - powershell

```
[19.10.2025 00:03:58] Set registry property: HKCU:\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Advanced; TaskbarAnimations, 0
[19.10.2025 00:03:58] Set registry property: HKCU:\Software\Microsoft\Windows\DWM; EnableAeroPeek, 0
[19.10.2025 00:03:58] Set registry property: HKCU:\Software\Microsoft\Windows\DWM; AlwaysHibernateThumbnails, 0
[19.10.2025 00:03:58] Set registry property: HKCU:\Control Panel\Desktop; DragFullWindows, 1
[19.10.2025 00:03:58] Set registry property: HKCU:\Control Panel\Desktop\WindowMetrics; MinAnimate, 0
[19.10.2025 00:03:58] Set registry property: HKCU:\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\ContentDeliveryManager; SubscribedContent-310093Enabled, 0
[19.10.2025 00:03:58] New registry path: HKCU:\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\BackgroundAccessApplications\Microsoft.Windows.Photos_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:03:58] Set registry property: HKCU:\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\BackgroundAccessApplications\Microsoft.Windows.Photos_8wekyb3d8bbwe; Disabled, 1
[19.10.2025 00:03:58] Set registry property: HKCU:\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\BackgroundAccessApplications\Microsoft.Windows.Photos_8wekyb3d8bbwe; DisabledByUser, 1
[19.10.2025 00:03:58] New registry path: HKCU:\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\BackgroundAccessApplications\Microsoft.YourPhone_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:03:58] Set registry property: HKCU:\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\BackgroundAccessApplications\Microsoft.YourPhone_8wekyb3d8bbwe; Disabled, 1
[19.10.2025 00:03:58] Set registry property: HKCU:\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\BackgroundAccessApplications\Microsoft.YourPhone_8wekyb3d8bbwe; DisabledByUser, 1
[19.10.2025 00:03:59] Unload default user: HKLM:\MountDefaultUser
[19.10.2025 00:03:59] Run script: C:\Temp\defaults\Remove-AppxApps.ps1
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Clipchamp.Clipchamp_yxz26nhyzhsrt
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Microsoft.BingNews_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Microsoft.BingSearch_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Microsoft.BingWeather_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Microsoft.GetHelp_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Microsoft.MicrosoftOfficeHub_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Microsoft.MicrosoftSolitaireCollection_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Microsoft.OutlookForWindows_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Microsoft.Todos_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Microsoft.Windows.DevHome_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Microsoft.WindowsCamera_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Microsoft.WindowsFeedbackHub_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Microsoft.Xbox.TCUI_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Microsoft.XboxGamingOverlay_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Microsoft.XboxIdentityProvider_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Microsoft.XboxSpeechToTextOverlay_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: Microsoft.YourPhone_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: MicrosoftCorporationII.QuickAssist_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: MSTeams_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Removed AppX app: MSTeams_8wekyb3d8bbwe
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Import module: LanguagePackManagement
[19.10.2025 00:04:09] Language pack install: en-AU
[19.10.2025 00:18:25] Import module: International
[19.10.2025 00:18:25] Set-Culture: en-AU
[19.10.2025 00:18:26] Set-WinSystemLocale: en-AU
[19.10.2025 00:18:26] Set-WinUILanguageOverride: en-AU
[19.10.2025 00:18:26] Set-WinUserLanguageList: en-AU
WARNING: If the Windows Display Language has changed, it will take effect after the next sign-in.
[19.10.2025 00:18:26] Set-WinHomeLocation: 12
[19.10.2025 00:18:26] Set-SystemPreferredUILanguage: en-AU
[19.10.2025 00:18:26] Copy locale settings to system: en-AU
[19.10.2025 18:18:27] Set-TimeZone: AUS Eastern Standard Time
[19.10.2025 18:18:27] New directory: C:\WINDOWS\System32\update\run\f38de27b-799e-4c30-8a01-bfdedc622944
[19.10.2025 18:18:27] Copied C:\Temp\defaults\* to C:\WINDOWS\System32\update\run\f38de27b-799e-4c30-8a01-bfdedc622944
[19.10.2025 18:18:27] Install-Defaults.ps1 complete. Elapsed time: 18:15:04.9741850
0
PS C:\Temp\defaults>
```



Preferences, not Policies



Policies vs. Preferences

	Policy	Preferences
In-built apps	Target & remove with Intune	Remove in gold image Windows Autopilot
First run popups / wizards	Intune policies	Set in gold image Windows Autopilot
Start menu	Force Start menu via Intune	Set default in gold image Windows Autopilot
Wallpaper, settings etc.	Force via Intune policies	Set default in gold image Windows Autopilot

Microsoft 365 Apps

Prepare

- Microsoft 365 Apps admin center
- Configuration files (configuration.xml)

Deploy

- Win32 package
- Installing Microsoft 365 Apps with Visio and Project

Manage

- Policy configurations
- Viewer mode

Customizing the Microsoft 365 Apps

m365apps - O365ProPlusVisioProRetailProjectProRetail.xml

```
<AppSettings>
  <Setup Name="Company" Value="stealthpuppy" />
  <User Key="software\microsoft\office\16.0\common\toolbars" Name="customuiroaming" Value="1" Type="REG_DWORD" App="office16" Id="L_AllowRoamingQuickAccessToolBarRibbonCustomizations" />
  <User Key="software\microsoft\office\16.0\common\general" Name="shownfirstrunoptin" Value="1" Type="REG_DWORD" App="office16" Id="L_DisableOptinWizard" />
  <User Key="software\microsoft\office\16.0\common\languageresources" Name="installlanguage" Value="3081" Type="REG_DWORD" App="office16" Id="L_PrimaryEditingLanguage" />
  <User Key="software\microsoft\office\16.0\common\fileio" Name="disablelongtermcaching" Value="0" Type="REG_DWORD" App="office16" Id="L_DeleteFilesFromOfficeDocumentCache" />
  <User Key="software\microsoft\office\16.0\common\general" Name="disablebackgrounds" Value="0" Type="REG_DWORD" App="office16" Id="L_DisableBackgrounds" />
  <User Key="software\microsoft\office\16.0\firstrun" Name="disablemovie" Value="1" Type="REG_DWORD" App="office16" Id="L_DisableMovie" />
  <User Key="software\microsoft\office\16.0\firstrun" Name="bootedrtm" Value="1" Type="REG_DWORD" App="office16" Id="L_DisableOfficeFirstrun" />
  <User Key="software\microsoft\office\16.0\common" Name="default ui theme" Value="0" Type="REG_DWORD" App="office16" Id="L_DefaultUIThemeUser" />
  <User Key="software\microsoft\office\16.0\excel\options" Name="defaultformat" Value="51" Type="REG_DWORD" App="excel16" Id="L_SaveExcelfilesas" />
  <User Key="software\microsoft\office\16.0\onenote\options\other" Name="runsystemtrayapp" Value="0" Type="REG_DWORD" App="onent16" Id="L_AddOneNoteicontonotificationarea" />
  <User Key="software\microsoft\office\16.0\outlook\preferences" Name="disablemanualarchive" Value="1" Type="REG_DWORD" App="outlk16" Id="L_DisableFileArchive" />
  <User Key="software\microsoft\office\16.0\outlook\autodiscover" Name="zeroconfigexchange" Value="1" Type="REG_DWORD" App="outlk16" Id="L_AutomaticallyConfigureProfileBasedOnActive" />
  <User Key="software\microsoft\office\16.0\outlook\options\rss" Name="disable" Value="1" Type="REG_DWORD" App="outlk16" Id="L_TurnoffRSSfeature" />
  <User Key="software\microsoft\office\16.0\outlook\setup" Name="disableroamingsettings" Value="0" Type="REG_DWORD" App="outlk16" Id="L_DisableRoamingSettings" />
  <User Key="software\microsoft\office\16.0\powerpoint\options" Name="defaultformat" Value="27" Type="REG_DWORD" App="ppt16" Id="L_SavePowerPointfilesas" />
  <User Key="software\microsoft\office\16.0\word\options" Name="defaultformat" Value="" Type="REG_SZ" App="word16" Id="L_SaveWordfilesas" />
</AppSettings>
```

Tools to build a great user experience

What's in the toolbox for Nerdio Manager and Microsoft 365 customers

Windows PCs

Windows Autopilot or Device preparation policies

Device pre-provisioning

Customization package

Microsoft 365 Apps Win32 custom package

Intune device configuration profiles

Sync via M365 Apps, OneDrive, Edge

Windows 365

Gold images and/or Device preparation policies

Customization package

Microsoft 365 Apps Win32 custom package

Intune device configuration and compliance profiles

Sync via M365 Apps, OneDrive, Edge

Azure Virtual Desktop

Gold images

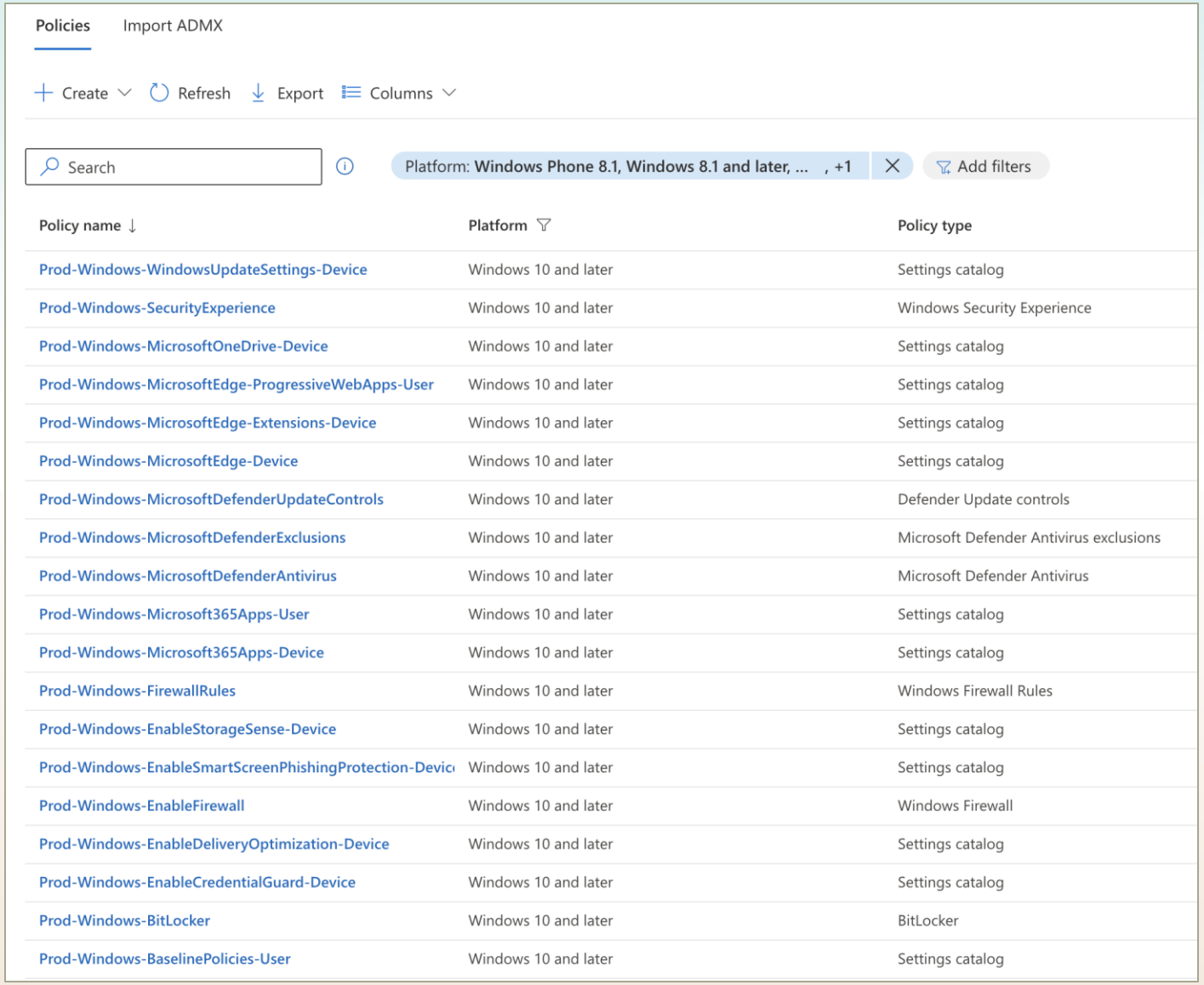
Customization package

Microsoft 365 Apps custom package

Intune device configuration profiles or Group Policy

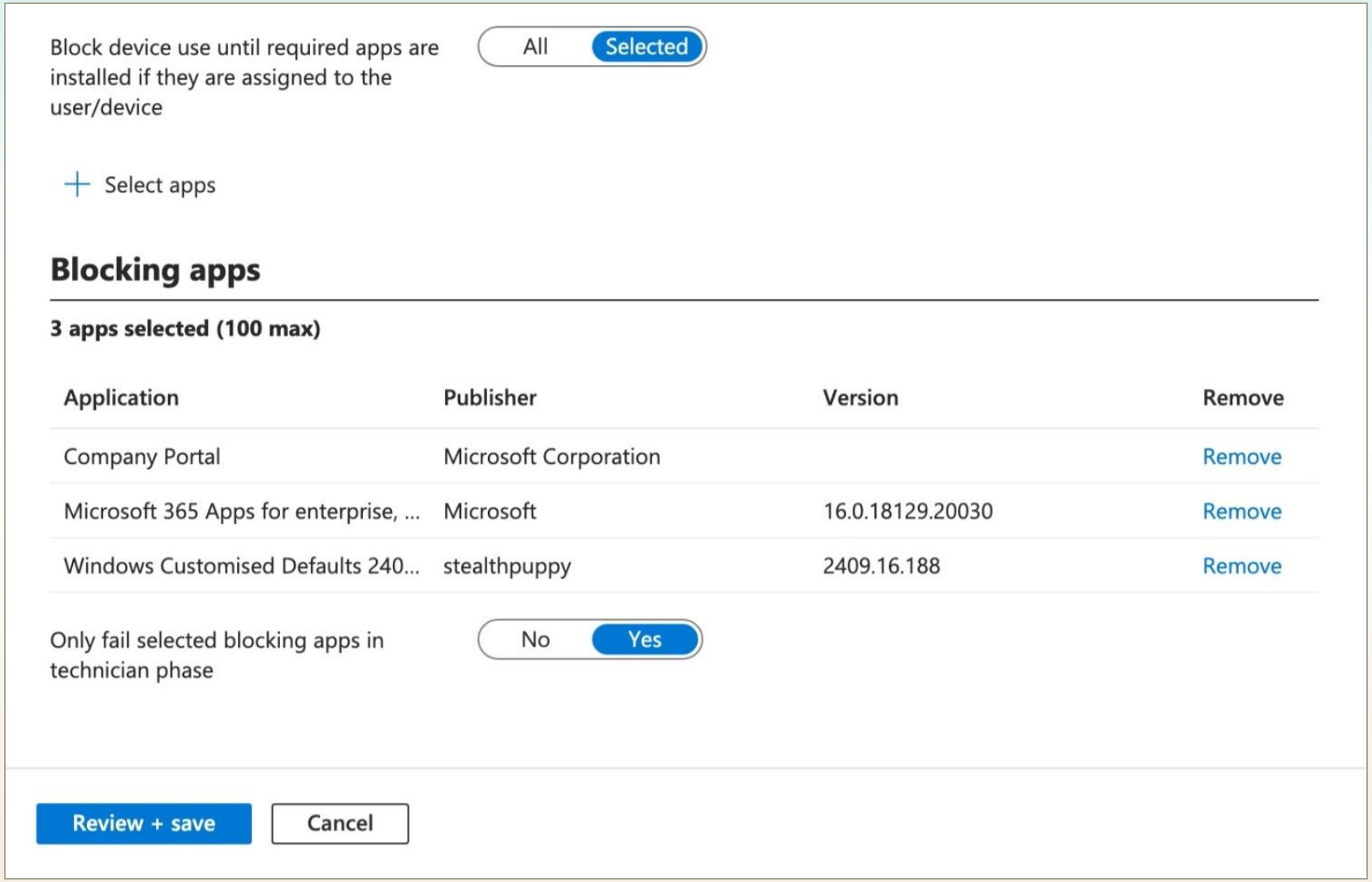
Sync via M365 Apps, OneDrive, Edge

Intune Configuration Profiles



Policy name	Platform	Policy type
Prod-Windows-WindowsUpdateSettings-Device	Windows 10 and later	Settings catalog
Prod-Windows-SecurityExperience	Windows 10 and later	Windows Security Experience
Prod-Windows-MicrosoftOneDrive-Device	Windows 10 and later	Settings catalog
Prod-Windows-MicrosoftEdge-ProgressiveWebApps-User	Windows 10 and later	Settings catalog
Prod-Windows-MicrosoftEdge-Extensions-Device	Windows 10 and later	Settings catalog
Prod-Windows-MicrosoftEdge-Device	Windows 10 and later	Settings catalog
Prod-Windows-MicrosoftDefenderUpdateControls	Windows 10 and later	Defender Update controls
Prod-Windows-MicrosoftDefenderExclusions	Windows 10 and later	Microsoft Defender Antivirus exclusions
Prod-Windows-MicrosoftDefenderAntivirus	Windows 10 and later	Microsoft Defender Antivirus
Prod-Windows-Microsoft365Apps-User	Windows 10 and later	Settings catalog
Prod-Windows-Microsoft365Apps-Device	Windows 10 and later	Settings catalog
Prod-Windows-FirewallRules	Windows 10 and later	Windows Firewall Rules
Prod-Windows-EnableStorageSense-Device	Windows 10 and later	Settings catalog
Prod-Windows-EnableSmartScreenPhishingProtection-Devic	Windows 10 and later	Settings catalog
Prod-Windows-EnableFirewall	Windows 10 and later	Windows Firewall
Prod-Windows-EnableDeliveryOptimization-Device	Windows 10 and later	Settings catalog
Prod-Windows-EnableCredentialGuard-Device	Windows 10 and later	Settings catalog
Prod-Windows-BitLocker	Windows 10 and later	BitLocker
Prod-Windows-BaselinePolicies-User	Windows 10 and later	Settings catalog

Enrollment Status Page



Deep dive

Physical PCs

1. Enroll Windows VM into Autopilot
2. Assign Autopilot profile
3. Review Intune policies and assignments
4. Package Microsoft 365 Apps
5. Review Customized Defaults
6. Validate Autopilot profile assignment
7. Sign into Windows PC
8. Review first sign-in user experience

Windows 365 & AVD

1. Review Desktop images
2. Review Microsoft 365 Apps packages
3. Review PowerShell scripts
4. Review Customized Defaults
5. Review Intune policies and assignments
6. Review first sign-in user experience

Take aways

Good UX is key to perceived & actual performance

Windows Autopilot requires considered configuration & expectations

Configure enterprise-ready defaults for Windows, Edge, M365 etc.

Microsoft 365 provides key services to sync user preferences

Enable users to move seamlessly across physical & virtual with minimal effort



Thank You



Resources

Windows Enterprise Defaults



Intune policies



Microsoft 365 Apps packager



Scripted actions

